Lesson plan · for the teacher

Prompts that fit your class

AI · Level 2 · Lesson 2

Time
40 min

Materials
Board and chalk; A weak prompt and the answer it got, prepared at home and copied on the board; Ingredient cards: Role, Context, Format, Example (one set per group); Your phone, to test one prompt (optional)

Learning goals

- Name the four ingredients of a good prompt.
- Add context that an AI tool could not guess.
- Predict how one ingredient changes an answer.

Activity: Prompt makeover

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask a volunteer to “draw an animal” on the board, with no more detail. Then ask for “a goat eating grass under a mango tree”. Ask the class: why is the second drawing closer to what I wanted?
2. Teach (8 min): Write the four ingredients on the board: role, task, context, format. Show the weak prompt you prepared and the answer it got. Ask: what did the AI not know about our class?
3. Makeover (15 min): Give each group one ingredient card. Groups rewrite the weak prompt by adding their ingredient, then write one sentence predicting how the answer will change.
4. Predict and compare (8 min): Groups read their prompts and predictions aloud. Choose the strongest prompt; if you have a phone, test it and read the new answer aloud, then compare it with the predictions.
5. Wrap-up (4 min): Ask: what did the AI need to know that only we could tell it? Agree that context makes answers fit. Then give the exit ticket.

Before class, give a chatbot a weak prompt, such as “Write questions about plants”, and copy its answer. Make one set of ingredient cards per group: Role, Context, Format, Example. No phone in class? Prepare an improved answer at home and read it out.

Discussion

- Why did the short prompt get such a general answer?
- Which ingredient changed the answer most?
- What should never go into a prompt, and why?

Exit ticket

- Rewrite “Make a quiz” with a role, context and a format.

Try it at school tomorrow
Run a “prompt makeover”: Show a weak prompt and the answer it got. Each group adds one ingredient (a role, the context or a format) and predicts how the answer will change. If you have a phone, test one prompt together.

Practice questions · for you

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1 **The AI's lesson plan is good, but too long for Amina's 40-minute lesson. What should she do?**

◯ Use it and rush the end ◯ Start again in a new chat ◯ Follow up: "Fit it into 40 minutes."

2 **Match each ingredient to its part of this prompt.**

Role	• • • •	"My 55 pupils have no lab equipment, and many read below grade level."
Task	• • • •	"Number them; under 15 words each."
Context	• • • •	"You are a Primary 4 science teacher in Ghana."
Format	• • • •	"Write five questions about the water cycle."

3 **Which details would help a chatbot plan a lesson for your class? Choose all that apply.**

☐ Resources you have, or don't have ☐ The language pupils speak at home ☐ Class size

☐ Pupils' age and level ☐ Pupils' full names

4 **Complete the sentence about this prompt: "You are a science teacher. Write five questions about the water cycle. Number them; under 15 words each."**

It has a role, a task and a _____, but no _____, so the AI will write for a _____ class.

Word bank: rule · quiet · context · format · typical

✎ **Write one prompt you could use this week, with all four ingredients. What does the AI need to know about your class that it can't guess?**

Check your answers

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1. **Follow up: "Fit it into 40 minutes."**

   A follow-up keeps everything that was good and fixes the length.

2. **Role — "You are a Primary 4 science teacher in Ghana."**
   Task — "Write five questions about the water cycle."
   Context — "My 55 pupils have no lab equipment, and many read below grade level."
   Format — "Number them; under 15 words each."

   A role says whose view to take, the task what to make, context what only you know, and the format how the answer should look.

3. **Pupils' age and level; Class size; Resources you have, or don't have; The language pupils speak at home**

   Age, class size, resources and home language change what will work in your room.

4. **It has a role, a task and a format, but no context, so the AI will write for a typical class.**

   The prompt gives a role, a task and a format (numbered, under 15 words each), but says nothing about the class, so the AI can only guess a typical one.